

THE PATH TO HOUSING RECOVERY

NEPAL EARTHQUAKE 2015: HOUSING RECONSTRUCTION



APRIL 2019

Fourth Anniversary Edition



Photo: HRRP Nepal

The Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform (HRRP) was launched in December 2015. HRRP took over supporting coordination of the post-earthquake housing reconstruction from the Nepal Shelter Cluster which returned to the pre-earthquake format as a standing cluster. The platform provides coordination support services for the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), Building and Grant Management and Local Infrastructure (GMALI) Central Level Programme Implementation Units (CLPIUs), other relevant government authorities, and Partner Organisations (POs). HRRP is currently in its third phase which will run until the end of July 2019. Planning for a fourth phase of the platform is underway. HRRP is funded by DFID Nepal and CRS Nepal and with in kind contribution from PLAN and OXFAM. Implementing partners include Oxfam, Plan International, and the National Society for Earthquake Technology Nepal (NSET).

The HRRP works at municipal, district, and national levels, providing support primarily to the 14 districts most affected by the earthquake, as well as roving support to the 18 districts moderately affected by the earthquake. The platform has personnel with expertise in general coordination, technical coordination, and information management across all working levels and areas. At national level the platform also has expertise in Monitoring Evaluation Accountability and Learning (MEAL), operations, and translation.

The HRRP's main areas of focus are:

- **Monitoring and documenting the housing reconstruction process**
- **Facilitating coordination and experience sharing to support improvements in coverage and quality of socio-technical assistance**
- **Supporting collective planning and roll out of additional support for vulnerable households**
- **Addressing gaps and duplications**
- **Advocacy, communications, and research**



Members of the HRRP team with the NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyawali.

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THE PATH TO HOUSING RECOVERY

NEPAL EARTHQUAKE 2015: HOUSING RECONSTRUCTION
April 2019

First Edition: April, 2018
Second Edition: May, 2018
Third Edition: September 2018
Fourth Edition: April 2019



www.hrrpnepal.org

Introduction

As of 15 April 2019, the Grant Management and Local Infrastructure (GMALI) Central Level Programme Implementation Unit (CLPIU) reports that of the 824,452 households eligible for the 300,000 NPRs GoN housing reconstruction grant, 92.4% have now signed the partnership agreement with the GoN, 91.7% have received the first tranche (50,000 NPRs), 68.5% have received the second tranche (150,000 NPRs), and 49% have received the third tranche (100,000 NPRs). Of the 63,693 households eligible for the GoN housing retrofit grant, 32% have signed the partnership agreement with the GoN, 30% have received the first tranche (50,000 NPRs), and 27 households have received the second tranche (50,000 NPRs). Through these grants, the GoN has so far disbursed more than 1.46 billion USD to earthquake affected households. In addition, more than 150 million USD has been invested by the GoN and Partner Organisations (POs) in socio-technical assistance.

The Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA), published by the GoN in June 2016, identified housing as the most affected sector with the per capita average cost of earthquake damage ranging from 255,860 NPRs in Dolakha to 43,800 NPRs in Makwanpur, at an average of 130,000 NPRs per person across the 14 most affected districts. The PDNA also estimated that an additional 2.5% to 3.5% of the population, at least 700,000 people, would be pushed into poverty in the year following the quake as a result of the disaster.

Immediately after the April 2015 earthquake, emergency shelter assistance was provided to more than 1.2 million houses in the 14 most affected districts. The response then progressed to addressing temporary shelter needs with 699,157 households in the 14 most affected districts receiving a 15,000 NPRs cash grant, or shelter materials



of an equivalent value. The GoN, through the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA), began planning the owner-driven housing reconstruction programme in June 2015. The programme includes a housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs, provided by the GoN in three tranches linked to compliant construction; 50,000 NPRs upon signing a partnership agreement with the GoN, a further 150,000

NPRs after completing the foundation, and a final 100,000 NPRs after completing the walls. A retrofitting grant of 100,000 NPRs is also available to households whose homes have been partially damaged. This grant is provided in two tranches of 50,000 NPRs. The NRA and HRRP defined a core package of socio-technical assistance activities to complement the GoN financial assistance.

As of 12 September 2018, the Grant Management and Local Infrastructure (GMALI) Central Level Programme Implementation Unit (CLPIU) reports that of the 810,196 households eligible for the 300,000 NPRs GoN housing reconstruction grant, 89% have now signed the partnership agreement with the GoN, 88% have received the first tranche (50,000 NPRs), 61% have received the second tranche (150,000 NPRs), and 32% have received the third tranche (100,000 NPRs). Of the 50,784 households eligible for the GoN housing retrofit grant, 18% have signed the partnership agreement with the GoN, 16% have received the first tranche (50,000 NPRs), and just one household has received the second tranche (50,000 NPRs). Through these grants, the GoN has so far disbursed more than 1.35 billion USD to earthquake affected households. In addition, more than 150 million USD has been invested by the GoN and Partner Organisations (POs) in socio-technical assistance.

This document presents a timeline of key points so far in the housing recovery, as well as including a pre-earthquake section in an attempt to highlight the decades of work on earthquake preparedness and response in Nepal which preceded 25 April 2015. It is hoped that this timeline has already contributed to, and will continue to contribute to increased awareness and understanding of the huge number of policies, procedures, and guidelines that have been developed for the recovery process. The timeline also highlights the winter and monsoon seasons to emphasise the impact that they have on construction seasons.

There are many lessons from the recovery process so far which demand reflection; we must learn from these and carry them forward in the years ahead to the completion of the housing reconstruction. Overall, this timeline looks to emphasise the enormous efforts made by all recovery actors, at all levels, but most of all by those in earthquake affected communities, to achieve the progress over the past four years.



Photo: People in Need

Key principles for reconstruction as identified in the PDNA:

- Reconstruction should empower communities to take control of their recover facilitated through the Owner Driven Reconstruction (ODR) approach.
- Reconstruction should apply “integrated safer settlement” principles where appropriate, involving the principles of holistic habitat development with an emphasis on basic services and community infrastructure.
- Reconstruction should become a vehicle for building long-term community resilience.
- Reconstruction should strengthen the local economy through processes supportive of the poor, marginalised and informal sector. It should provide an opportunity for the poor to upgrade their overall living and eqconomic conditions.
- Reconstruction should ensure sustainable and environmentally conscious processes that keep in mind issues such as climate change, natural resource management, and scientific riskassessments.
- Reconstruction should be equitable and inclusive, with equal rights to land and property accorded to women.
- Reconstruction should be initiated through targeted strategies that address the specific needs of the diverse communities and settlements affected by the earthquakes.

1934

15 January

Nepal-Bihar earthquake of 8.4M results in more than 8,519 deaths in Nepal



Bhaktapur Darbar Square before and after 1934 Earthquake



Photo: National Seismological Centre Nepal

1988

21 August

6.9M earthquake resulted in 721 deaths in Nepal

Ministry of Physical Planning and Works (MPPW) established.
Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC) also established with 26 divisional offices and Town Development Executive Committees (TDECs). These are the government institutions responsible for urban development and housing planning in Nepal.



Lumanti Support Group for Shelter registered as an NGO.
 Organisation is "dedicated to alleviating urban poverty in Nepal through integrated approach of improving shelter conditions".



NSET
 Earthquake Safe Communities in Nepal

National Society for Earthquake Technology - Nepal (NSET) established (registered as an NGO in 1994)

1993

South-central part of Nepal experienced unprecedented floods, landslides, and debris flows following heavy rainfall in July and August. The total effect of the two events was 1,460 people dead or missing, 73,606 families seriously affected, and 39,043 houses destroyed.

1987

Ministry of Housing and Physical Planning established

1959

10 municipalities in Nepal



1992

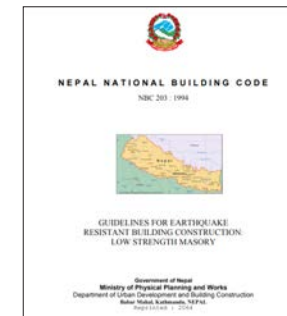


26 new municipalities declared, brings total to 36

National Building Code Development Project (BCDP) starts

1994

Nepal National Building Code published



1997

Building Act passed. Introduces provisions for building permits to be issued by Municipalities and Village Development Committees (VDCs)

1999

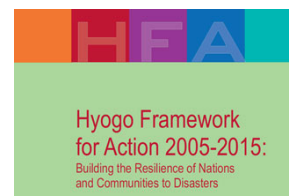
Department of Housing, Building, and Infrastructure renamed **Department of Urban Development and Building Construction** (DUDBC)

Local Self-Governance Act passed. Delegated authority for the design and implementation of DRR activities to local government through District Development Committees (DDCs), municipalities and Village Development Committees (VDCs)

2005

18-22 January

Second World Conference on Disaster Reduction, **Hyogo Framework for Action** (2005–2015) agreed, Government of Nepal commits to national level implementation of the framework.



2008

Koshi river flood affects more than 11,500 households across 6 districts. Shelter cluster (and other clusters) activated and shelter cluster becomes standing cluster

Draft **Contingency Plan for Emergency Shelter** prepared by DUDBC with support from UNOCHA, IFRC, and UN HABITAT.



Photo: Nepal Army

1996

22 new municipalities declared, brings total to 58



Disaster Preparedness Network-Nepal (DPNet-Nepal) formed as an umbrella organisation for national and international agencies, with the objective of facilitating coordination, collaboration, learning and experience sharing, and avoiding duplication in emergency response.

Government of Nepal publishes the **National Action Plan for Disaster Risk Management**

National Shelter Policy defines the role of central government in shelter delivery as a facilitator, rather than a provider.

Ministry of Home Affairs published **National Comprehensive Plan on Disaster Management**. The plan emphasised the improvement of national capacity for disaster management and institutional structures.

2007

National Urban Policy published by the Ministry of Physical Planning and Works (MPPW). Policy includes framework for reduction of vulnerability to risk through local level planning on the road network, open spaces, etc.



Nepal Risk Reduction Consortium (NRRC) formed with five flagships; 1 – school and hospital safety, 2 – emergency preparedness and response, 3 – flood management in the Koshi river basin, 4 – community based disaster risk management, and 5 – policy / institutional support for Disaster Risk Management (DRM)

2009

May

Government of Nepal approves **National Strategy for Disaster Risk Management**

Ministry of Federal Affairs and Local Development (MoFALD) produces **Local Disaster Risk Management Planning** (LDRMP) guidelines for municipalities and VDCs

18 September

Sikkim earthquake of 6.9M killed 11 people in Nepal, caused damage to 100s of houses in eastern Nepal, as well as triggering landslides



Photo: China Daily

April

'Guidelines for masons training on earthquake resilient building construction' published by UNDP and Government of Nepal. Guidelines are for training existing masons on earthquake resilient techniques and will form the foundation of the 7 day masons training course used after the 2015 Gorkha Earthquake.



Photo: NSET

October

NSET-Nepal launch **'Building Code Implementation Program in Municipalities of Nepal' (BCIPN)** with funding support from US Office of Foreign Disaster Assistance (USAID/OFDA). BCIPN works to build capacity of municipalities to implement building code. In 2010, just 10% of houses in BCIPN working areas were fully compliant. In 2015, after 3 years of the BCIPN programme, this number had jumped to 50% and a further 30% of houses were very close to compliance and could be considered earthquake resilient.

2011

2012

20



Under NRRC flagship 4, **'Nine Minimum Characteristics'** for a disaster resilient community in Nepal are agreed with DRR actors and government.

Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA) produces **Disaster Preparedness and Response Plan (DPRP)** guidelines for district level and suggests DPRPs should be prepared at VDC level also

MoHA formalised **'District Lead Support Agency' (DLSA)** role and a DLSA was appointed for each of the 75 districts to support with preparation of Disaster Preparedness and Response Plans (DPRPs) and disaster response if required

18 May

Ministry of Urban Development formed

MoFALD produces **'Guidelines for the formulation of District Disaster Management Plans'**

13

April

Under the Local Governance and Community Development Programme (LGCDP) **ICT volunteers are deployed** in 75 District Development Committees (DDCs) and in 50 municipalities

May

72 new municipalities declared, brings total to 130

**14-18 March**

Government of Nepal delegation joins global DRR community at **UN World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction in Sendai, Japan** where a new international framework for DRR, the Sendai Framework, is agreed



UN World Conference on
Disaster Risk Reduction
14-18 March 2015, Sendai, Japan

15 March

Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA) publish report **identifying open spaces in the Kathmandu Valley** which could be used for humanitarian purposes in the event of an earthquake.

2014

2015



Photo: GoN Ministry of Irrigation

2 August

Massive landslide in Jure, Mankhaa

Village Development Committee, Sindhupalchowk caused loss of life, displaced 5,000 families, and created a high artificial dam across the Saptakoshi River, one of the main tributaries of the Koshi River, blocking the flow of water completely.

14-16 August

Heavy rain caused **massive floods and several landslides across 18 districts** affecting almost 35,000 families and killing 53 people. The floods and landslides damaged roads, bridges, local markets, transport vehicles as well as livestock and crops. More than 1,240 houses were destroyed and 435 houses were damaged.

December

61 new municipalities declared, brings total to 191

**April**

District Lead Support Agencies (DLSAs)

Terms of Reference (ToR) revised by Ministry of Home Affairs (MoHA)

May 2015

25 April 2015

M7.6 earthquake, 11:56 NST
epicentre Gorkha
 8,790 people died
 22,300 people injured

Emergency shelter support provided to **1.2 million+ households**, this included tarpaulins, blankets and bedding. In the first few weeks of response, biggest providers of emergency food and shelter support were local businesses, CSOs, and communities themselves – demonstrating a high level of solidarity and local strength in response.

Initial Rapid Damage Assessment conducted by the Government of Nepal, **Red Card** system launched to identify earthquake beneficiaries



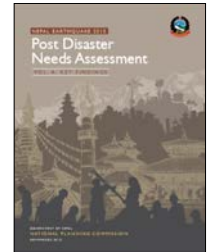
Shelter Cluster Nepal launches **Technical Working Group (TWG)** on Technical Assistance and Training for Recovery



Photo: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

25 June

Post Disaster Needs Assessment (**PDNA**) launched



APRIL

MAY

JUNE



Photo: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

12 May

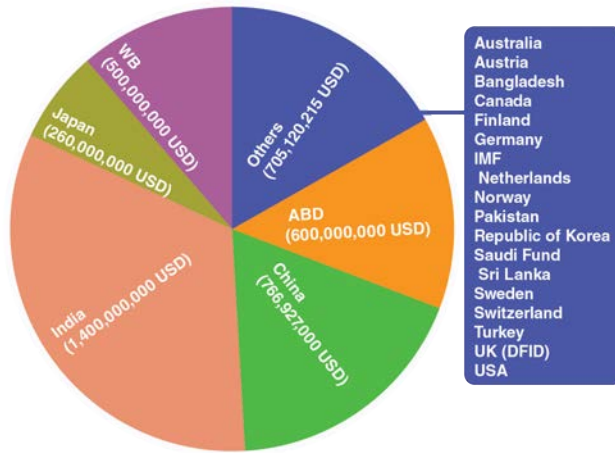
Biggest **aftershock**, **M7.3**, 12:50 NST
epicentre Dolakha
 218 died
 2500+ injured

15 Partner Organisations reporting emergency shelter support (shelter cluster 4w)

PO

Temporary shelter support starts.
GoN / POs provide cash grant of **15,000 NPRs** or material equivalent to **650,000+ households**.





4.4 billion USD (two thirds of total appeal) committed by international donors to support recovery and reconstruction at donor conference.

August 2015

13 August

Cabinet establishes **National Reconstruction Authority (NRA)**,
Dr. Govinda Raj Pokharel appointed CEO

31 August

NRA loses legal status

September 2015

16 September 2015

Constitution promulgated

26 new municipalities

declared, brings total 217



1,430 masons trained
by Partner Organisations
(POs) and GoN
(HRRP 4W)

JULY

AUGUST

SEPTEMBER

June – September Monsoon season, generally less construction work takes place

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai

July 2015



Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)

74%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

67%

19 August

Flowminder reports that, with the exception of Rasuwa, all of the 14 of most affected districts, have experienced an inflow of people since the earthquake



Shelter Cluster

10 September

Shelter Cluster Recovery and Reconstruction Working Group (RRWG) launched

POs report 200 million USD in place for housing recovery and reconstruction. Shelter Cluster estimates indicate this would be enough to cover the delivery of the **minimum socio-technical assistance package** to all affected households in the **32 districts**.



Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)

72%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

51%

WET

Minimal construction during monsoon (June - September)

October 2015

DUDBC Design Catalogue Vol. 1 published. The catalogue states "It is not mandatory for households to select a design from this catalogue, and they are free to prepare house designs outside of the catalogue but these designs must comply with the National Building Code".



Photo: Chetraj Ojha, DLPIU

25 December

Mr. Sushil Gyawali appointed as CEO

21 December

Reconstruction Act 2072 issued and NRA's **Policy Act** formed

7 December

National Consultation Workshop on the draft **National Plan of Action for Safer Building Construction** prepared by the Ministry of Urban Development (MoUD) and Department of Urban Development and Building Construction (DUDBC)

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

October 2015 – March 2016: Winterisation support of 10,000 NPRs in cash or in-kind support provided based on Shelter Cluster guidance.

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders



Photos: Shelter Cluster, Nepal

HRRP Phase 1 launched, led by IOM and UN Habitat, taking over responsibility for supporting the coordination of the housing recovery efforts from the Nepal Earthquake Shelter Cluster.



115 Partner Organisations reporting emergency shelter support (shelter cluster 4w)

PO



Shelter Cluster

31 December

The Nepal Shelter Cluster reverts to pre-earthquake form as a standing cluster focusing on preparedness and contingency planning

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD

15 January

CBS Detail Damage Assessment starts



Photo: HRRP Nepal

March 2016**13 March 2016**

A pilot enrolment held in **Singati, Dolakha**, for households from Lamidada and Laduk VDCs.

31 March

Cabinet approved NRA
NGO Mobilisation Guidelines launched.

15 January - 20 June: Detailed Damage Assessment conducted by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), to determine eligibility for GoN housing reconstruction grant in 11 of the most affected districts (not including three Kathmandu Valley districts). 762,106 households surveyed using a census model in which each household is visited and assessed by a trained enumerator.

JANUARY

FEBRUARY

MARCH

September 2015 – March 2016, unrest in the Terai and blockade at the borders

BBC Media Action research

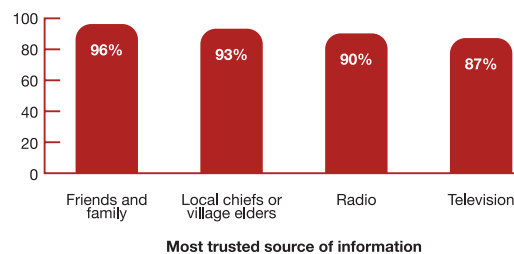
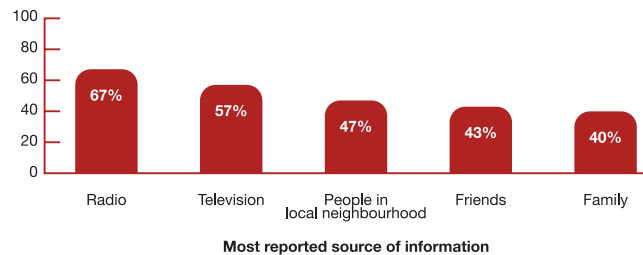


Photo: HRRP Nepal

62 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction (HRRP 4w)

PO

April 2016

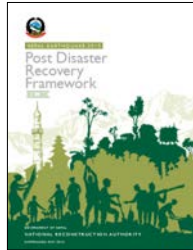
20,160 masons trained by POs (HRRP 4W)



Mid-April
NRA begins signing reconstruction grant agreements in 10 districts outside Kathmandu Valley

May 2016

Post Disaster Recovery Framework (PDRF) launched



June 2016

GoN deploys **2,500+ engineers, sub-engineers, and assistant sub-engineers** supporting housing reconstruction in 14 worst affected districts.



Photo: DLPIU Gorkha

APRIL

MAY

JUNE



Photo: CRS Nepal

24 May

450+ aftershocks reported with magnitudes equal to or above M4 since April 25th 2015 (51 equal to or above M5, 5 above M6). 20,000+ aftershocks of less than M4 reported.

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)



82%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not know how to access reconstruction support

62%

68 Partner Organisations supporting housing reconstruction (HRRP 4W)

PO

July 2016

7th NRA Steering Committee meeting agrees to increase the GoN housing reconstruction grant from 200,000 NPRs to 300,000 NPRs.



August 2016

Procedures for handling of grievances related to reconstruction published by NRA



Photos: CRS Nepal

September 2016

29,340 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)



JULY

AUGUST

SEPTEMBER

11 July - 15 September: The Detailed Damage Assessment, conducted by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), to determine eligibility for the GoN housing reconstruction grant is carried out in three Kathmandu Valley districts. Almost 114,414 households are surveyed under a system in which households certified by the local village and municipal authorities as earthquake-affected are assessed.

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project



Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)

74%

Do not feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Do not have the information they need to access reconstruction support

67%



Phase 2 of the HRRP launched, led by IOM

WET

Minimal construction during monsoon (June - September)

October 2016

Community Reconstruction Committees Directive published by NRA

November 2016

Inspection guidelines and associated Inspection Forms published by NRA.



December 2016

19 December
Participation Agreements signed by **475,000+** households in **11 districts**, almost **450,000** received **first tranche** of the reconstruction grant. (GoN Reports)

25 December
First phase of **geo-hazard risk assessment** begins. NRA teams deployed.

29 December
Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquakes approved by Cabinet

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER



Photo: HRRP Nepal



25 November

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage (HRRP 4W)

9

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

296



Photo: Baliyo Ghar, NSET

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD

January 2017

10 January

Dr. Govind Raj Pokharel appointed
NRA CEO

Refinancing Procedures for
Reconstruction of Private Houses
published by NRA

Government of Nepal publishes **National
Urban Development Strategy**

31 January

Cabinet approves **first revision
to NRA NGO Mobilisation
Guidelines**



March 2017

DUDBC Design Catalogue Volume 2
published, including designs for alternative
technologies such as confined hollow concrete
block masonry, hollow concrete block masonry,
compressed stabilised earth block masonry,
bamboo and stone masonry hybrid structures,
and timber structures.

Inspection Forms (first and second inspection)
published for dry stone masonry, and houses
constructed using sun-dried bricks.



46 new municipalities declared, brings total
to 263

21 November 2016 – 14 April 2017: Detailed damage assessment, conducted by Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS) to determine eligibility for GoN housing reconstruction grant, carried out in 18 'moderately affected' districts. 176,428 households surveyed with system in which local village and municipal authorities certify households as earthquake affected.

JANUARY

FEBRUARY

MARCH

25 January

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(HRRP 4W)

9

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

171

February 2017

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)



55%

Do not feel their main reconstruction
needs are being addressed

Now have the information they
need to access reconstruction support

58%

PO

81 Partner Organisations
supporting housing reconstruction
(HRRP 4w)



Phase 3 of the **HRRP** launched,
led by CRS Nepal



May 2017

7 May
Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquakes revised to reflect **increase in grant** (from 200,000 NPRs to 300,000 NPRs) and **repair and retrofitting grant** (100,000 NPRs)



14 May

First phase of local elections.
 The ToR set out for Locally Elected Bodies.

April 2017



43,310 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)

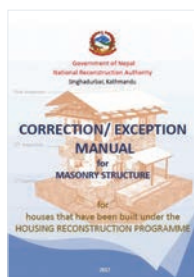
7 April

Cabinet approves **second revision to NRA NGO Mobilisation Guidelines**

7 May
Partnership Agreements process begins in **18 moderately affected districts** with households eligible for reconstruction grant

15 May

Corrections and Exceptions Manual published by NRA.



Inspection form for houses constructed with dry stone masonry published by NRA.

NRA toll-free number launched.
 16600172000 (NTC), 9801572111 (NCELL)

Procedures for interest-free loans to earthquake victims based on collective guarantee published by NRA

June 2017

23 June

Criteria for purchasing habitable lands for earthquake victims published by MoFALD CLPIU.



28 June

Second phase of local elections.

27 'District Support Engineers' deployed across 14 districts by NRA, with support from UNDP, based in the MoUD DL-PIU offices, provide guidance and back up for field engineers.



Under Federal Administration restructuring **6 metropolitan cities, 11 sub-metropolitan cities, 276 municipalities, and 460 rural municipalities** are declared

Local Governance and Community Development Programme (LGCDP) allocates budget to all 753 municipalities (under new administrative structure) for **hiring of IT officer**

APRIL

MAY

JUNE

Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
 (2100+ Respondents)



53%

Feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Have the information they need to access reconstruction support

75%



Source: MoFALD
 June 2017

25 April

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
 (HRRP 4W)

25

VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

149



July 2017

Deadlines set by NRA for Disbursement of Housing Reconstruction Grant.
Grant agreement signing: November 16, 2017
First tranche: January 13, 2018
Second tranche: April 13, 2018
Third tranche: July 15, 2018



Photo: People in Need

August 2017

Relocation and Rehabilitation of Hazard-prone Settlements procedures published by NRA

Flooding. 12 districts heavily affected.
 9,850 houses destroyed
 301,500 families affected
 44,700 families temporarily displaced
 131 people killed
 32 people missing
 30 people injured



September 2017

51,270 masons trained by POs and GoN (HRRP 4W)

18 September

Third phase of local elections.

25 September

Repair and Retrofitting Manual for Masonry and RCC Structures and **Hybrid Structures Manual** published by NRA

Government of Nepal passes the **Disaster Management Act**. Includes provision for establishment of a National Disaster Management Agency (NDMA).

10 August – 16 September 2017: resurvey and verification conducted to address grievances with detailed damage assessment

JULY

AUGUST

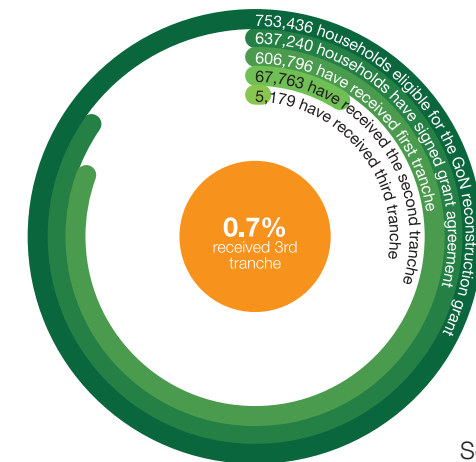
SEPTEMBER



Photos: Pradipraj Onta



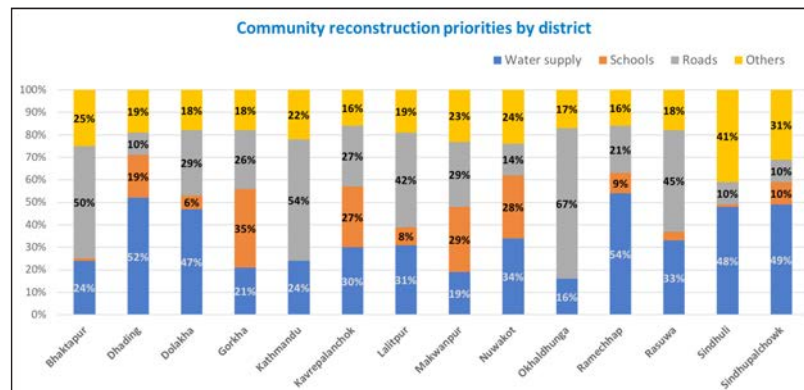
Photos: Niranjan Shrestha



Source: MoFALD
September 2017

WET

Minimal construction during monsoon (June - September)



December 2017 Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project report. **Water supply remains an issue in 14 districts** (see graph). 37% of respondents say water supply is the biggest community reconstruction need followed by roads (31%) and schools (13%).

The report recommends continued restoration of access to necessary water supply for affected communities.

December 2017

450+ engineers, sub-engineers, and assistant sub-engineers deployed by the GoN to support housing reconstruction in the **18 moderately affected districts**.

Flood Post Disaster Needs Assessment (PDNA) launched

October 2017

23 October

Mr. Yuburaj Bhusal appointed NRA CEO

7 November

Inspection form for houses constructed with sundried bricks published by NRA.



7 December

Second phase of federal and provincial elections.



26 November

First phase of federal and provincial elections.

31 December

Local Governance and Community Development Programme (LGCDP) support for social mobilisation under local authorities ends.

5,000+ social mobilisers supporting reconstruction no longer employed under local authorities

OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

Average house construction cost is 675,000 NPRs (approx. USD 6,750).

Almost 60% of respondents are or are planning to build using stone masonry with an average cost of 550,000 NPRs (approx. USD 5,500).

56% have taken loans (or are planning to) to reconstruct their home, at an average interest rate of 23% p.a. (HRRP report on the cost of construction)

The Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2100+ Respondents)



50%

Feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Have the information they need to access reconstruction support

76%

25 October

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(HRRP 4W)

26

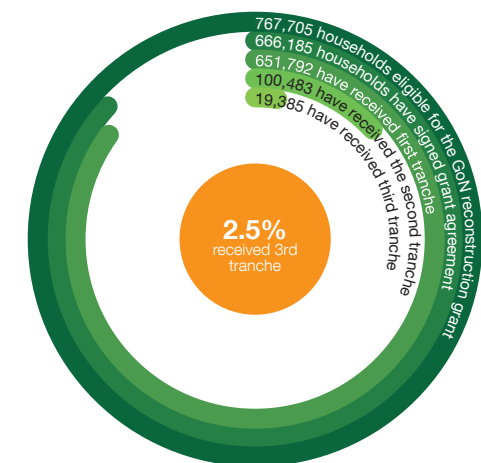
VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA

134



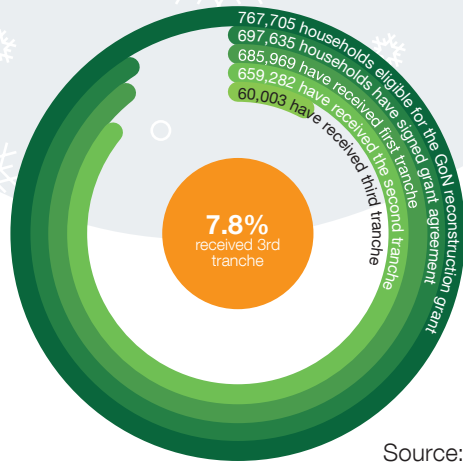
21 November
Clearing Away the Rubble: Moving Beyond Blockages to Reconstruction Progress launched (HRRP and Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project)



Source: MoFALD
December 2017

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)

COLD.

Source: MoFALD
March 2018

JANUARY

FEBRUARY

MARCH

9 February

Deadlines extended by NRA.
 Second tranche disbursement by
 13 April 2018

21 February
Project Monitoring
Information System
 launched by NRA

28 February
NRA toll-free number
 responded to **8,691 calls.**

March 2018

54,179 masons trained by
 POs and GoN, (HRRP 4W)



Light Timber / Steel
Frame Structure Manual
 published by NRA.

25 February

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
 (HRRP 4W)

27 VDCs with minimum package of STA

VDCs with no STA **124**



9 March

Women in Reconstruction Event.
 Continued gaps in effectively engaging
 and supporting women in housing
 reconstruction highlighted.

15 March

Temporary Shelter Status: 90%+ of
 respondents living in temporary shelter
 have not modified or improved their
 shelter since it was built

Women in Reconstruction: almost
 50% women respondents have signed
 the Partnership Agreement with
 government in their own name.

Community Reconstruction
Committees (CRCs): 50%+ of
 CRCs not receiving any support from
 reconstruction actors.
 (HRRP surveys and research)

PO

102 Partner Organisations
 supporting housing recovery
 (HRRP 4W)

April 2018

3 April

Deadlines extended by NRA.

Second tranche disbursement by 16 July 2018

3 April

the MoUD and MoFALD Central and District Level Programme Implementation Units (**CLPIU and DLPIUs**) became the **Building and GMALI CLPIU and DLPIUs** and moved under the NRA

APRIL



Source: MoFALD
April 2018

May 2018

15 May

NRA published list of 18,505 households identified as vulnerable and requiring additional support for their housing recovery. These households were identified based on the following criteria:

- Senior Citizens above 70
- Single women above 65
- Persons living with disabilities (red and blue card holders)
- Children under 16

MAY

The Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2580 Respondents)



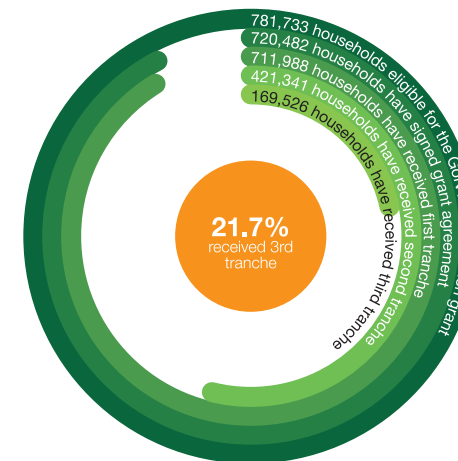
68%

Feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Have the information they need to access reconstruction support

85%

CFP and HRRP analysis **estimates 20% of houses being constructed are one room, one storey and 61% are two rooms, one storey**. When compared with CBS damage assessment data on pre-earthquake floor areas it appears that the reconstruction is causing a big change in house size.



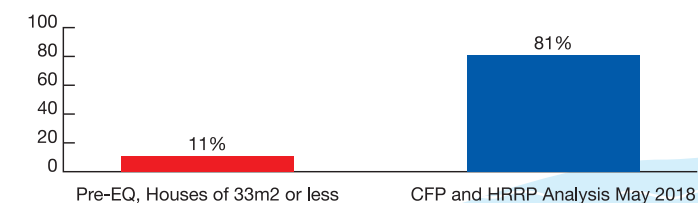
Source: Building and GMALI CLPIUs
June 2018

JUNE

30 June

HRRP 4W phased out. Tracking of Partner Organisation activities **transitioned to NRA 5W**.

Comparison Pre and Post EQ



September 2018

16 July
Deadline for
disbursement of
second tranche
passes



Gatlang, Rasuwa: traditional house in the background and one room, one storey house being constructed in the foreground. The one room, one storey house is being constructed simply to access the Government of Nepal housing reconstruction grant.
Photo: DFID/Magnus Wolfe-Murray

3 September
Report on NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff survey published. 51% did not receive training before deployment and 45% of respondents reported facing pressure or threats from households to pass their house and 29% reported facing pressure or threats from ward / municipal officials to pass certain houses.

6 September
NRA Steering Committee **extends tranche disbursement deadlines**; new deadline for second tranche disbursement is 15 January 2019 and new deadline for third tranche disbursement is 14 May 2019. The deadlines do not apply for households identified as eligible for the reconstruction / retrofit grant by re-survey/verification, households in traditional settlements, and households that need to relocate. Steering Committee also decides to give the **responsibility for monitoring and approving housing reconstruction / retrofit grant disbursement to municipal governments.**

11 September
NRA, GMALI CLPIU, Building CLPIU, and HRRP launch **municipal survey and action planning process** across 32 earthquake affected districts.

25 September
'Interest subsidy on subsidised loan policy guideline 2075' circulated by Nepal Rastra Bank to BFIs. Provides for loan of up to 300,000 NPRs with a loan period of between 5 and 10 years. The bank and financial institutions should not exceed 2% in their base rate for this loan. The government will subsidize 5% of total interest rate and the household will bear the remaining.

28 September
National Association of Rural Municipalities in Nepal (NARMIN) launch a mobile app providing information on rural municipalities, including news and contact details for officials

JULY

July 2018

NRA announced **approval of vulnerable support projects** under five organisations; Mercy Corps, Care Nepal, People in Need, NRCS, and Practical Action

HRRP **transitioned its data structures from VDCs to Municipalities**. 617 VDCs (earlier) to **282 Municipalities** and **2553 Municipal Wards** (later)

24 July

First meeting of **Hollow Concrete Block Technical Working Group (TWG)**. The TWG includes representatives from NRA and Building CLPIU on the GoN side as well as representatives from the Partner Organisations (POs) Build Change, NRCS, and NSET. The HRRP technical coordination team is facilitating the TWG.

AUGUST

August 2018

24 Partner Organisations supporting housing recovery (NRA 5W)

14 August

Sushil Gyawali appointed as CEO of the NRA. Mr Gyawali has served as CEO of the NRA previously from 25 December 2015 to 11 January 2017

PO

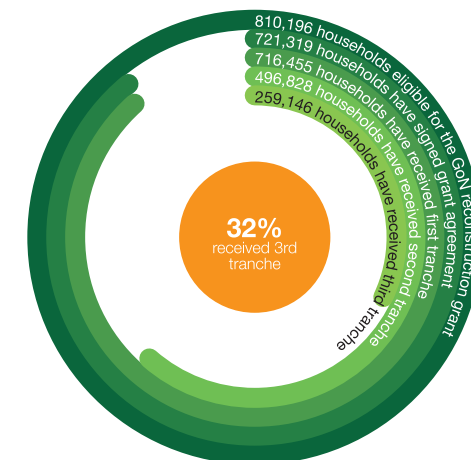
27 August

Municipal Association of Nepal (MuAN) launch mobile app providing information on municipalities, including news and contact details for officials.

SEPTEMBER



52,951 masons trained by POs and GoN (NRA 5W)



Source: Building and GMALI CLPIUs
September 2018

WET

Minimal construction during monsoon (June - September)

November 2018

HRRP and ASF Nepal survey in Ward No. 3, Aamo Chhindgimo Rural Municipality, Rasuwa (Gatlang) found that of the houses built under the housing reconstruction programme **71% are one room houses and 26.5% are two room houses.**

5 November

NRA meeting on 'Strategy for Training and Orientation on Housing Reconstruction' for municipalities and to put in place an adequate information dissemination framework from national to local level and vice versa.

October 2018

1-5 October

Members of the HRRP team represent the Nepal earthquake recovery at the **Global Shelter Cluster Annual Shelter Week** in Geneva Switzerland.

December 2018

20 December

Government cabinet meeting passes the disaster risk management regulations paving the way for the establishment of the **National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority.**

20 December

Shelter Cluster Nepal Lessons Learned Workshop to review the cluster performance after the earthquake in order to contribute to improvements in cluster performance for future disasters.

23 November

UK Shelter Forum: NRA CEO, Sushil Gyewali, addressed the forum through a pre-recorded video and also answered questions via live video conference during the panel discussion on recovery in Nepal

21 December

Donor level meeting on 'Improving Support to the most Vulnerable': this meeting was organised by HRRP and the discussion was focused on how to better support vulnerable households through government in areas where there are no Partner Organisations (POs) and effective methods to disseminate effective solutions in collaboration with government and local authorities.

25 December

Third anniversary of the establishment of the National Reconstruction Authority

Honorable Prime Minister KP Oli laying the foundation stone of the Dharara tower as part of celebrating the third anniversary of the NRA.



OCTOBER

NOVEMBER

DECEMBER

22 Partner Organisations supporting housing recovery (NRA 5W)

PO

The Inter-Agency Common Feedback Project

Periodic Household Survey
(2580 Respondents)



72%

feel their main reconstruction needs are being addressed

Now have the information they need to access reconstruction support

88%

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(NRA 5W)

168

municipal-wards with minimum package of STA

municipal-wards with no STA

1733



26 November 2018 - 21 Jan 2019: District Level Reconstruction Orientation affected districts; as part of this the NRA signed an MoU with all 2

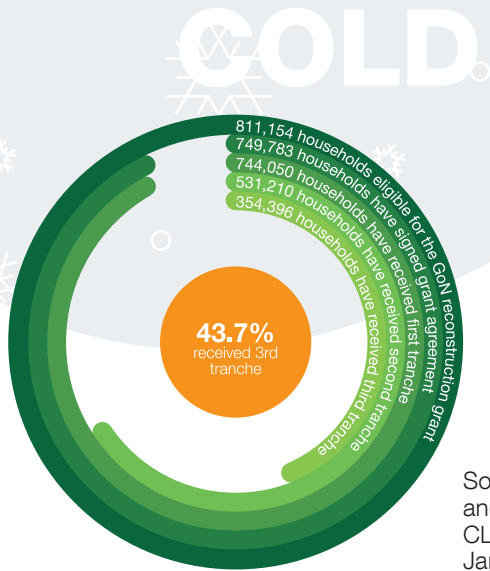
25 December

NRA Executive Committee Meeting approves **'Integrated Settlement Development Guideline 2075'**



Source: Building and GMALI CLPIUS December 2018

Construction challenges during Winter (November - February)



Source: Building
and GMALI
CLPIUs
January 2019

February 2019

Deadline for second and third tranches of Housing Reconstruction Grant removed.

HRRP3 is extended for five months to run up to the end of July 2019.

4 February

Council of ministers agrees **revisions to the 'Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquake (Second Amendment), 2075'.**

7 February 2019

NRA Hollow Concrete Block Manual is published

13 February

Launch in Kathmandu of new ALNAP (Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in Humanitarian Action) **lessons paper capturing learning from earthquake response** worldwide over the past decade, including the 2015 Nepal earthquake response.



5-7 March

Nepal Red Cross Society holds **'Movement-Wide lessons learned workshop of the Nepal Post 2015 Earthquake Operation'**

17 March

DLPIU technical staff go on strike, closing DLPIU offices and ceasing all work.



Engineers outside the locked DLPIU office in Gorkha.

29 March 2019

NRA launches the **final round of reverification and resurvey** for households missed during previous surveys or who had registered a grievance related to the result of their previous survey.

JANUARY

Evacuation and Review Workshops held in all 32 earthquake affected municipalities by the earthquake.

16 January

Earthquake Safety Day is celebrated across Nepal.



Search and rescue simulation in Nuwakot as part of Earthquake Safety Day.

21 January

An **interactive housing typology dashboard is launched on the HRRP website**. The dashboard is available on the homepage of the website - www.hrrpnepal.org

FEBRUARY

18 February

100th edition of the HRRP bulletin

18 February

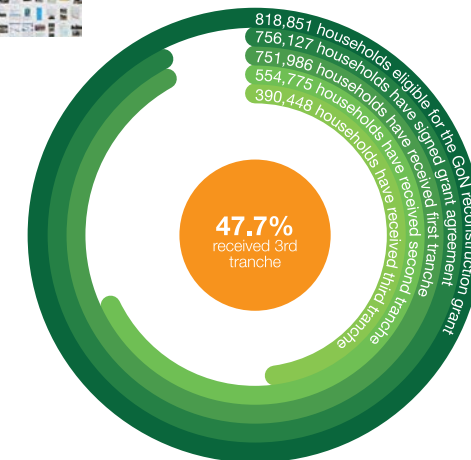
Report on **'Causes Behind Delays in Housing Reconstruction Progress in the Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Programme (EHRP), A Study of Rural Municipalities of Lalitpur'** published by the NRA Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist for Lalitpur, Okhaldhunga, and Rasuwa.

19 February

Round table discussion on support to vulnerable households held by HRRP Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG)



MARCH



Source: Building
and GMALI
CLPIUs
March 2019

April 2019

13 Partner Organisations
supporting housing recovery (NRA 5W)

PO

66,249 masons trained by POs and
GoN, (NRA 5W)



APRIL

Socio-Technical Assistance (STA) coverage
(NRA 5W)

168

municipal-wards with
minimum package of STA

municipal-wards with no STA

1674



“The quality of the housing reconstruction will determine how the overall reconstruction is viewed, if the housing reconstruction is well managed and effective then the reconstruction programme will be considered a success.”

General Nadeem
Retired Director of the Pakistan ERR
Speaking with Shelter Cluster partners on 8 October 2015



Ward 9, Gorkha Municipality, Gorkha: Sanju Bishwakarma is a lead mason and is known for her skill in steel fixing. Although female masons report that some families are reluctant to hire them, many people now seek out Sanju based on her reputation for high-end work. She is also building her own home but has faced delays in receiving the GoN housing reconstruction grant due to an error in the agreement, but this is being corrected and she will then be able to receive the tranche payments. She has supported other women to come through a 50-day mason training provided by CRS and Caritas.

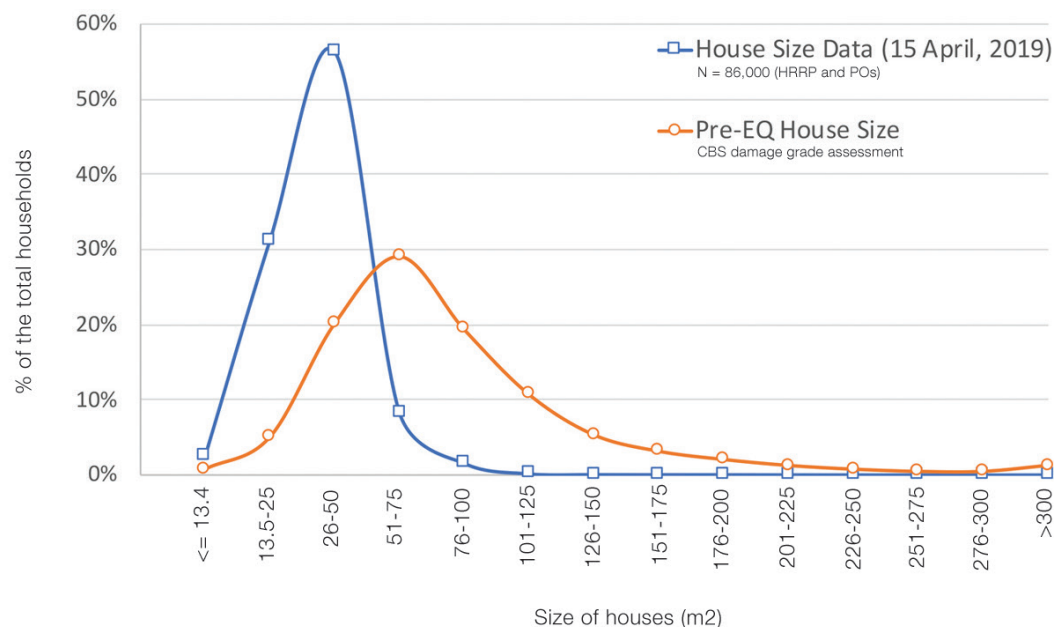
Photo credit: Jen Hardy/CRS.

Conclusion

The fourth anniversary of the April 2015 Gorkha Earthquake provides an opportunity to remember the tragic loss of life and immense destruction to housing and infrastructure across such a large part of Nepal. It also provides an opportunity to reflect on the many positives of the recovery process to date; more than 1.46 billion USD has been disbursed to earthquake affected households by the Government of Nepal (GoN) through housing reconstruction and retrofit grants, more than 3,000 technical staff have been deployed by the GoN to carry out inspections and provide advice to households, more than 53,000 masons have been trained, a comprehensive geo-hazard risk assessment has been completed by the NRA and as of April 2019, 44% of households eligible for the GoN relocation grant have resettled and a further 56% are in the process of resettling, the government has agreed revisions to policy and procedures to improve access to financial assistance, and international donors and Partner Organisations have provided significant support to the GoN for the reconstruction efforts.

This is also a time to reflect on what lessons have been learned from the earthquake recovery so far, and to look at how these can be institutionalised to support an improved recovery process over the coming years, and for future disasters.

Big disasters drive change, and that change is generally not just in terms of the physical structures that are rebuilt but also in terms of the social and cultural aspects of housing and settlements. For example, data on house size compiled by the HRRP provides the following information on how house size has changed in earthquake affected areas since the 2011 census:



The graph clearly indicates that house sizes are generally becoming smaller under the reconstruction. Where more information is required is on the social and cultural impacts of this. Are there more houses being built, representing a move away from joint family living? Are there changes occurring in how houses are used or designed? Or are people planning to extend these small houses in future? If so, what information will they need access to make sure that any extension does not impact the earthquake resilience of their house?

It may also be interesting to review how the past 20 years of work in Nepal on building code implementation and safer construction has influenced the housing reconstruction happening now. This may allow for greater understanding of how the housing reconstruction might influence the next 20 years of work in Nepal on building code implementation and safer construction. This is particularly important in terms

of working to ensure that initiatives to improve construction practices under the reconstruction are sufficiently institutionalised and sustainable to have a wider effect on construction practices throughout Nepal. Key to this will be supporting, and crucially retaining, the government staff currently working on the housing reconstruction. The municipal and ward officials as well as the 1000s of technical staff that have been deployed in earthquake affected areas could have a positive role to play in building code implementation beyond the reconstruction. There is huge scope for exchange visits and learning events to provide opportunity for discussion and sharing that could extend the impact of the reconstruction beyond the earthquake affected districts. But this requires investment in facilitating this type of process, and more urgently local officials and technical staff need support in terms of continuous mentoring and training opportunities.



Ward No. 3, Naukunda Rural Municipality, Rasuwa: on the left of the photo are two single room houses, belonging to a father and son. There is a gap in between the houses but they have a common roof. Both father and son have received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. To the right of the photo is the family's pre-earthquake house which was damaged but which they are still using without applying any repairs / retrofit measures. This situation is very common in this ward, but also in other wards of Naukunda Rural Municipality, as many people have built single room houses but are continuing to live in their earthquake damaged house because the single room house is not sufficient for their living requirements.

“In reconstruction, it is better to have 100,000 people each concerned about one house than to have 100 people concerned about 10,000 houses.

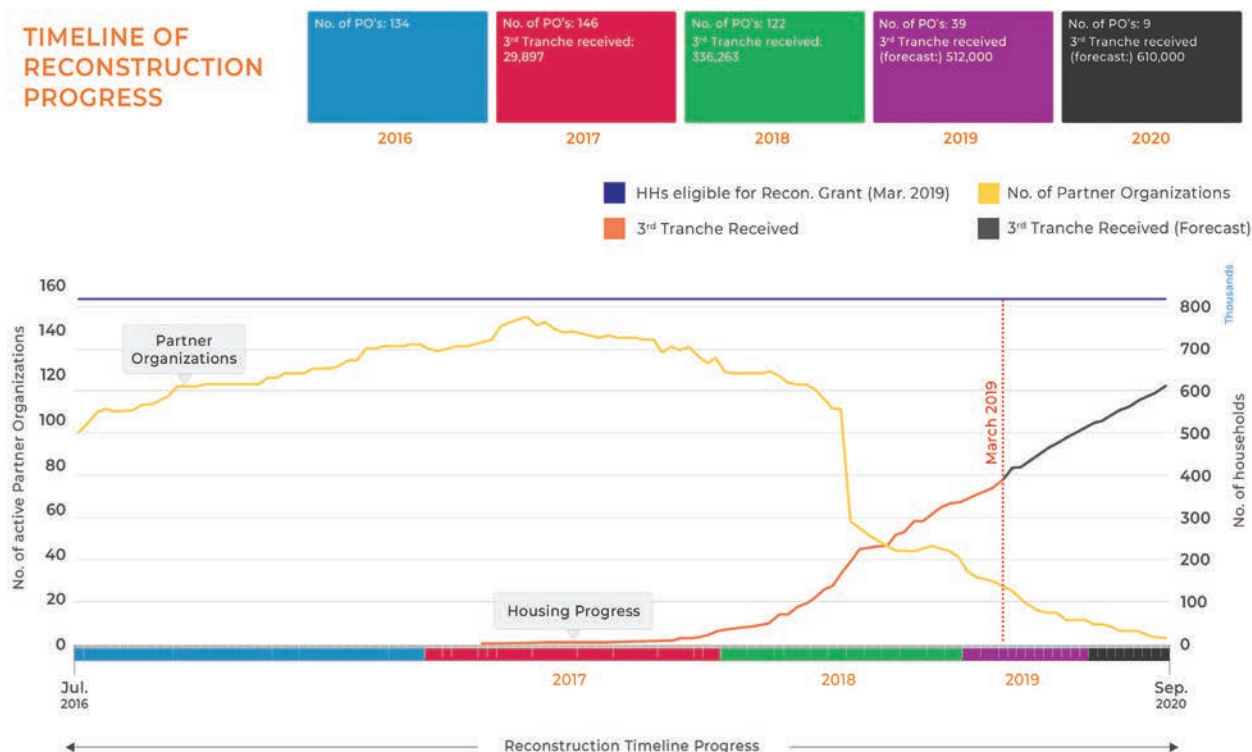
George Soraya, World Bank

Whilst there has been huge progress made on the housing reconstruction over the past four years, there is still a long way to go. There are more than 420,000 households yet to receive the third, and final, tranche of the government's financial assistance for housing reconstruction. However, the fourth anniversary seems to be coming at a time when interest and support for the housing reconstruction in Nepal is dropping significantly. The number of Partner Organisations (POs) supporting housing recovery has gone from more than 120 in late 2016 and early 2017 to less than 35 by March 2019.

It is a huge achievement on the behalf of the Government of Nepal to be getting financial assistance out to more than 820,000 households and to have established all the policies and guidelines required to do that; and to put in place the 1000s of engineers needed to manage the process. But that took time. And it took households time to prepare and plan before starting reconstruction - some households are still taking their time to plan before starting and some will need additional time because their recovery process is more complicated. Whilst much of the early support from POs on areas such as mason training and demonstration construction has been very positive, and should be encouraged, the limitations in coverage of technical assistance provided by POs as well as the drop off in this support at a key moment in the reconstruction represents a challenge.

RECONSTRUCTION PROGRESS : A BRIEF PROJECTION OF RECONSTRUCTION STATUS

TIMELINE OF RECONSTRUCTION PROGRESS



“If we aim to ensure people are supported to take informed action, whether through building codes or other measures, we should anticipate an iterative process that is continuously learning, responding to opportunities and challenges.”

Where there are challenges there are always opportunities. The National Reconstruction Authority will soon deploy a significant number of senior engineers, social mobilisers, and mobile masons to provide technical assistance at household and community level. This presents an important opportunity to scale up coverage of technical assistance, and to improve the quality of technical assistance provided. Recent revisions to the grant disbursement procedures saw the deadlines for disbursement of the grant removed and introduced provisions for people that were living in a house owned by another person, and who become homeless as a result of damage caused to that house, to be eligible to receive the housing reconstruction grant. In historical settlements households are now eligible to receive an additional 50,000 NPRs if they rebuild using traditional architecture. People whose houses are damaged as a result of the demolition of attached earthquake damaged houses can now also be listed as eligible for the housing reconstruction grant. These are very positive steps and represent opportunities to advance the reconstruction in urban areas and to address some of the issues that impact most on vulnerable households.

Perhaps most importantly though, all reconstruction actors need to take the opportunity of the fourth anniversary of the 2015 earthquake to reflect on the years ahead. The housing reconstruction will take time and will require sustained support that offers flexibility to be responsive to changes in needs over time and across different contexts. This will require coordination to be embraced at all levels and to foster an open, collaborative approach amongst all reconstruction actors.

“Leadership and coordination in a single programme: Vision and leadership by Government, coordination between all assistance actors, consensus on complementary roles and clear objectives, and in a spirit of collaboration and common purpose. Instead of a multitude of projects, all agencies implemented the same programme using resources efficiently to cover the entire affected area.”

Kashmir Earthquake 2005, Learning from The Shelter
Response and Rural Housing Recovery
Habib Mughal, Sheikh Ahsan Ahmed, Hamid Mumtaz,
Babar Tanwir, Sumera Bilal, Maggie Stephenson



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